

## **Ahmad Khoshniat**

PhD Candidate, Visual and Performing Arts

Teaching Associate

Harry W. Bass Jr. School of Arts, Humanities, and Technology

University of Texas at Dallas

Email: [Ahmad.Khoshniat@utdallas.edu](mailto:Ahmad.Khoshniat@utdallas.edu)

Website: [ahmadkhoshniat.com](http://ahmadkhoshniat.com)

## **EDUCATION**

### **University of Texas at Dallas (UTD), USA**

#### **PhD Candidate, Visual and Performing Arts**

August 2022 – present | GPA: 3.86/4.0

- Dissertation (Practice-as-Research), in progress:

“Creating a Transnational Political Image Through Experimental Animation: Bridging Resistant Strategies of Iranian Art Cinema with Anti-hegemonic Aesthetics”

- Creative Project: *Sensorship*

An experimental animated short film exploring the political image through visual and cinematic form.

### **Tehran University of Art, Tehran, Iran**

#### **MA in Animation**

September 2014 – October 2017 | GPA: 3.87/4.0

### **University of Applied Science & Technology, Tehran, Iran**

#### **BA in Architecture**

January 2011 – February 2013 | GPA: 3.93/4.0

### **University of Applied Science & Technology, Tehran, Iran**

#### **Associate Degree in Civil Engineering**

January 2008 – February 2010 | GPA: 3.88/4.0

## **RESEARCH INTERESTS**

Investigating cinematic form as a site of political meaning through experimental animation and film practice, with a focus on art cinema (especially Iranian art cinema), anti-hegemonic aesthetics, and transnational frameworks including intercultural and accented cinema.

## **TEACHING EXPERIENCE**

### **University of Texas at Dallas (UTD), USA**

#### **Teaching Associate (Instructor of Record):**

Spring 2026 – present

FILM 2332 – Understanding Film

Summer 2026: Online

Spring 2026: In-person

- Designed and delivered lectures, assignments, and assessments.

#### **Teaching Assistant:**

August 2022 – Fall 2025

FILM courses (4 semesters)

ART HISTORY courses (3 semesters)

ART courses (1 semester)

- Assisted faculty with grading, leading discussions, and supporting course instruction across eight semesters.

### **Farabi International Campus, Tehran University of Art, Tehran, Iran**

#### **Lecturer:**

February 2019 – December 2020

Animation Directing I & II (MA level)

- Taught graduate-level animation directing with emphasis on visual storytelling, pre-production, production, post-production, and creative direction.

#### **Teaching Certification:**

Effective Teaching 101: Starting the Semester Strong (ACUE), Association of College and University Educators, January 2026.

## **PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE**

### **FFTG Awards Film Fest, USA**

#### **Official Selection Committee Member**

2021

## **LEADERSHIP & SERVICE**

### **Bass School's Association of Graduate Students (AGS) Mentorship Program**

University of Texas at Dallas (UTD), USA

#### **Graduate Student Mentor**

Summer 2026

- Provided peer mentorship, guidance, and support to facilitate the transition into the Visual and Performing Arts (VPA) PhD program.

### **Bass School's Association of Graduate Students (AGS)**

University of Texas at Dallas (UTD), USA

#### **Visual and Performing Arts (VPA) Representative**

Fall 2025 – Spring 2026

- Advocated for graduate students in the Visual and Performing Arts program, facilitating communication between students and school administration, and supporting academic and professional development initiatives.

### **The College Student Scientific Society (Animation Division)**

Tehran University of Art, Tehran, Iran

#### **President**

2015 – 2016

- Organized animation-related academic events, screenings, workshops, and talks for the student community.

## **PUBLICATION**

Khoshniat, Ahmad. "Bertolt Brecht's Soul in the Body of Experimental Animation: Common Audiovisual Strategies between Epic Theatre and Robert Breer's Short Animations." *Avanca Cinema Journal*, No. 13 (2022): 61 – 71. <https://doi.org/10.37390/avancacinema.2022.a369>

Khoshniat, Ahmad. "Visual Method of Paronomasia in Amir-Hamzeh Animation as a Strategy for Creating a Musical-Literary Animated Narrative" In *Short Film Studies: Narration in Short Film*, 13-37. Tehran: JICA Publication, 2021.

Khoshniat, Ahmad. "Figurative Language Methods as Strategies of Socio-Political Criticism in Jan Švankmajer's Films." *Journal of Visual Art and Design*, No. 12 (2020): 56-78. <https://doi.org/10.5614/j.vad.2020.12.1.4>

Khoshniat, Ahmad. *Cryptic Arms: Jan Švankmajer's Filmmaking Techniques as Strategies of Sociopolitical Criticism*. Shiraz: ShivaTir, 2019.

Khoshniat, Ahmad. "Common Aspects Between Feature and Short Films in Applying Major Styles of Figurative Language" In *Short Film: Tehran International Short Film Conference 'Past, Present, Future'*, 183-205. Tehran: Aban Publication, 2018.

## **CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS**

Khoshniat, Ahmad. "Animating Presence in Experimental and Expanded Animation: Materiality, Performance, and Artistic Agency." *37th Society for Animation Studies (SAS) Conference: The Animate Experience*, Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania, USA. June 16, 2026.

Khoshniat, Ahmad. "The Unbreakable Bond Between Politics and Film in the History of Iranian Cinema." *Society for Cinema and Media Studies (SCMS) 2026 Conference*, Chicago, Illinois, USA, March 26, 2026.

Khoshniat, Ahmad. "Examining Experimental Animation Strategies and Pixilation to Develop a Body- and Mind-based Style." *Northeast Modern Language Association (NeMLA) 57th Annual Convention*, Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania, USA, March 6, 2026 (online).

Khoshniat, Ahmad. "Mythological Destabilization of Masculine Hegemony in Lucrecia Martel's *Salta Trilogy*." *International Association of Maternal Action & Scholarship (IAMAS 2025): (Re-)Producing Motherhood, Motherwork, and Mothering*, Boston University, Boston, Massachusetts, USA. June 19, 2025. (online)

Khoshniat, Ahmad. "Examining Experimental Animation and Pixilation as Bait to Develop an Engaging Personal Filmmaking Style." *16th Annual RAW Graduate Student Conference: Bait, Prompt, and Aid*, University of Texas at Dallas, Richardson, USA. March 1, 2025.

Khoshniat, Ahmad. "Mircea Eliade's Mythological Vision & Mark and Pearson's Archetypal Patterns Through Terrence Malick's Lens." *South Atlantic Modern Language Association (SAMLMA 96): Seen and Unseen*, Jacksonville, Florida, USA. November 16, 2024.

Khoshniat, Ahmad. "Bertolt Brecht's Soul in the Body of Experimental Animation: Common Audiovisual Strategies between Epic Theatre and Robert Breer's Short Animations." *AVANCA CINEMA: 13th International Conference on Cinema – Art, Technology, Communication*, Avanca, Portugal. July 28, 2022. (online)

Khoshniat, Ahmad. "Visual Method of Paronomasia in Amir-Hamzeh Animation as a Strategy for Creating a Musical-Literary Animated Narrative." *Second Tehran Seminar on Short Film Studies*, Tehran, Iran. October 4, 2020.

Khoshniat, Ahmad. “Common Aspects Between Feature and Short Films in Applying Major Styles of Figurative Language.” *Tehran International Short Film Conference: Past, Present & Future*, Tehran, Iran. November 8, 2016.

## **CREATIVE PRESENTATIONS**

Khoshniat, Ahmad. *The Redistribution of the Visible: Performance*. *17th Annual RAW Graduate Student Conference: Under the Surface: Visibility and Politics*, University of Texas at Dallas, Richardson, USA. February 21, 2026.

Khoshniat, Ahmad. *Cruel White: Performance & Installation*. *15th Annual RAW Graduate Student Conference: Fugly Aesthetics, Activism, Politics*, University of Texas at Dallas, Richardson, USA. February 17, 2024.

## **PUBLIC LECTURES**

Guest Lecturer, Art History (Dr. Jacquelyn Delin McDonald). “Framing Myth: From Sandro Botticelli’s Canvas to Terrence Malick’s Lens.” University of Texas at Dallas, USA. May 5, 2025.

## **EXHIBITIONS**

### **FLOWERS AND TREES (2026), Juried Exhibition**

MVA Art Gallery, Bethlehem, Pennsylvania, USA, July 29–August 28, 2026

Artwork included: **HUWOODMON** (from the *Natural Humonsters* series)

Medium: pencil, ink, marker, and colored pencil on paper (17 × 11 in; framed 19 × 13 in)

### **Landscape(s): Reimagining Our Shared Spaces, International Juried Exhibition**

Old Walls Gallery, Albuquerque, New Mexico, USA, April 3–24, 2026

Artwork included: **HUROCKMON** (from the *Natural Humonsters* series)

Medium: pencil, ink, marker, and colored pencil on paper (17 × 11 in; framed 19 × 13 in)

### **Before the Algorithm, Art Exhibition, Juried Exhibition**

The Courtyard Theater Gallery, Plano, Texas, USA, February 19–March 21, 2026

Artwork included: **HUMUDMON** and **HUROCKMON** (from the *Natural Humonsters* series)

Medium: pencil, ink, marker, and colored pencil on paper (17 × 11 in; framed 19 × 13 in)

**Artist as Catalysts for Social Change**, International Juried Exhibition

Ludington Area Center for the Arts (LACA), Ludington, Michigan, USA, October 3–31, 2025

Artwork included: **HUROCKMON** (from the *Natural Humonsters* series)

Medium: pencil, ink, marker, and colored pencil on paper (17 × 11 in; framed 19 × 13 in)

## **ACADEMIC HONORS & AWARDS**

**Dean’s Teaching Fellowship**, University of Texas at Dallas, 2026–2027. Competitive award for excellence in teaching and research.

**Dean of Graduate Education Dissertation Research Award**, University of Texas at Dallas, 2026. Competitive award supporting dissertation research.

**Robert Plant Armstrong Endowed Scholarship**, University of Texas at Dallas, 2026–2027.

**Harry W. Bass Jr. Graduate Research Award**, University of Texas at Dallas, Fall 2026.

**Harry W. Bass Jr. Graduate Research Award**, University of Texas at Dallas, Fall 2025.

**Bremer Travel Award**, University of Texas at Dallas, 2024–2025. Awarded for participation and presentation at SAMLA 96 Conference.

**Fully Funded PhD Scholarship**, University of Texas at Dallas, 2022–present. Comprehensive funding package for doctoral studies in Visual and Performing Arts.

**Best Paper Award**, 2nd Tehran Seminar on Short Film Studies, 37th Tehran International Short Film Festival, Tehran, Iran, 2021.

Paper: “Visual Method of Paronomasia in *Amir-Hamzeh* Animation as a Strategy for Creating a Musical-Literary Animated Narrative.”

**Best Paper Award**, Short Film Studies Conference “Past, Present, Future,” 33rd Tehran International Short Film Festival, Tehran, Iran, 2016.

Paper: “Common Aspects Between Feature and Short Films in Applying Major Styles of Figurative Language.”

## **FILM HONORS & AWARDS**

### **Khoshniat, Ahmad.**

*RED, BLACK & BLUE* (2023, 6 min.)

Co-director and co-producer with Dárë Akinwole

Editor and Sound Designer

#### **Awards**

- Best Director, Cosmic Film Festival, University of Texas at Dallas, USA, 2024.
- Best Sound Design, Cosmic Film Festival, University of Texas at Dallas, USA, 2024.
- Audience Choice Award, Cosmic Film Festival, University of Texas at Dallas, USA, 2024.

#### **Official Selections**

- Minnesota Film Festival, Minnesota, USA, 2025.
- 5th Ethereal Horror Fest, Austin, USA, 2024.
- 11th International Student Film Festival Opavský páv, Opava, Czech Republic, 2024.

### **Khoshniat, Ahmad.**

*WHEN L.R WEPT* (2022, 5 min. 30 sec.)

Director, Writer, Producer, Animator, Editor, and Sound Designer

#### **Awards**

- Honorable Mention, Student World Impact Film Festival (SWIFF), USA, 2023.

#### **Official Selections**

- IMPACTE! Human Rights Film Festival of Catalonia, Barcelona, Spain, 2024.
- 12th Annual Queens World Film Festival, USA, 2022.
- 39th Tehran International Film Festival, Iran, 2022.
- 17th Shorts Mexico: Mexico International Short Film Festival, Mexico, 2022.

### **Khoshniat, Ahmad.**

*V. CYCLE* (2019, 3 min. 45 sec.)

Director, Writer, Producer, Animator, Editor, and Sound Designer

#### **Official Selections**

- FFTG Awards, USA, 2020.
- 25th Linea d'Ombra Festival, Italy, 2020.
- Short Short Story Film Festival, USA, 2019.

**Khoshniat, Ahmad.**

*LOCKED* (2019, 11 min. 22 sec.)

Director, Writer, Producer, and Editor

**Awards**

- Jury's Sound Special Award, Kimera International Film Festival, Italy, 2021.
- Best Animation (Golden Earth Prize), International Cittadella GeoFilmFestival, Italy, 2020.

**Official Selections**

- 5th Chaniartoon: International Comic & Animation Festival, Greece, 2021.
- Link International Film Festival, United Kingdom, 2020.
- Festival Internacional de Cine Silente, Mexico, 2019.
- International Shahr Film Festival, Iran, 2019.
- Tehran International Animation Festival, Iran, 2019.

**Khoshniat, Ahmad.**

*For Freedom* (2016, 3 min. 20 sec.)

Director, Writer, Producer, Animator, Editor, and Sound Designer

**Official Selections**

- Cabriolet Film Festival, Lebanon, 2018.
- Bute Street Film Festival, United Kingdom, 2018.
- Festival Internacional de Cine Silente, Mexico, 2018.
- Constantine's Gold Coin Animated Film Festival, Serbia, 2017.
- Festival Cinema Invisible, USA, 2017.
- Asia Peace Film Festival, Pakistan, 2017.
- Derechos Humanos Festival de Cine Madrid, Spain, 2016.
- Wolves Independent International Film Awards, Latvia, 2016.
- 33rd Tehran International Short Film Festival (Book & Cinema Section – National Competition), Iran, 2016.
- Chandler International Film Festival, USA, 2016.
- Move Me Production Online Film Festival, Belgium, 2016.
- 4th Indian Cine Film Festival (ICFF), India, 2016.
- 12th Action on Film Festival, USA, 2016.

**Khoshniat, Ahmad.**

*Fashion Nazi* (2016, 1 min. 40 sec.)

Director, Writer, Producer, Animator, Editor, and Sound Designer

**Official Selections**

- Iranian Film Festival, USA, 2017.
- Kargil International Film Festival, India, 2017.
- Preview International Film Festival, Spain, 2017.
- Tehran International Animation Festival, Iran, 2017.



- International 100-Second Film Festival, Iran, 2017.
- Constantine's Gold Coin Animated Film Festival, Serbia, 2017.
- Short to the Point Online Film Festival, Romania, 2016.

**Khoshniat, Ahmad.**

*The Prophets of Terror* (2016, 4 min. 25 sec.)

Director, Writer, Producer, Animator, Editor, and Sound Designer

**Official Selections**

- Salento Finibus Terrae Film Festival, Italy, 2017.
- 13th Human Rights Film Festival of Barcelona, Spain, 2016.

**Khoshniat, Ahmad.**

*Unjust Matches* (2016, 3 min. 50 sec.)

Director, Writer, Producer, Animator, Editor, and Sound Designer

**Honors / Official Selection**

- Official Selection and Top 12 Ranking, FEELFEST International Online Festival, Spain, 2017.

## **PROFICIENCIES**

Animation & Video: TVPaint Animation, Adobe Premiere Pro

Sound Design: Nuendo

AI & Digital Media: Familiarity with and emerging use of generative AI tools in creative and pedagogical contexts

## **LANGUAGES**

Persian (Farsi): Native

English: Fluent (academic and professional proficiency)